

IT Salary Comparison Worksheet

NAME _____ DATE _____ PERIOD _____

Use this same packet on Days 2, 3, and 5. On Day 2, choose three programming or IT careers available in H&L or Xello and complete pages 1-3. On Day 3, your teacher will show you how to read the dated career data on page 4. Save page 5 for Day 5.

Career 1 Evidence Record

DAY 2 - HATS & LADDERS OR XELLO CAREER EVIDENCE

Exact career title: _____

App salary (Hats & Ladders or Xello, local figure)

- Platform: H&L / Xello
- Geography shown: _____
- Measure shown (range, median, or other): _____
- Figure: _____ Date viewed: _____

One task this worker does:

Common preparation (education, training, or certification):

Keep the labels. A local pay range and a national median are different measures. Page 4 uses one dated national source so you can compare three careers fairly.

Career 2 Evidence Record

DAY 2 - HATS & LADDERS OR XELLO CAREER EVIDENCE

Exact career title: _____

App salary (Hats & Ladders or Xello, local figure)

- Platform: H&L / Xello
- Geography shown: _____
- Measure shown (range, median, or other): _____
- Figure: _____ Date viewed: _____

One task this worker does:

Common preparation (education, training, or certification):

Career 3 Evidence Record

DAY 2 - HATS & LADDERS OR XELLO CAREER EVIDENCE

Exact career title: _____

App salary (Hats & Ladders or Xello, local figure)

- Platform: H&L / Xello
- Geography shown: _____
- Measure shown (range, median, or other): _____
- Figure: _____ Date viewed: _____

One task this worker does:

Common preparation (education, training, or certification):

Compare Three Programming Careers

The U.S. Bureau of Labor Statistics (BLS) reports national career information. **Median annual pay** is the middle wage, not starting pay. **Projected growth** estimates how the number of jobs may change; it is not a promise of a job. Your teacher will model how to read one row before you compare the three.

BLS OCCUPATION	MAY 2025 U.S. MEDIAN ANNUAL PAY	PROJECTED JOB GROWTH, 2025-2035
Software Developers	\$135,980	10%
Software Quality Assurance Analysts and Testers	\$104,300	6%
Web Developers	\$92,650	4%

Sources: U.S. Bureau of Labor Statistics, Occupational Outlook Handbook, [Software Developers, Quality Assurance Analysts, and Testers](#) and [Web Developers and Digital Designers](#), checked September 24, 2026. These are U.S. medians, not Irving or entry-level pay. Recheck before using this page in a later school year.

1. Which of these three careers has the highest national median? Name the career and amount.

2. Which has the fastest projected growth? Name the career, percent, and years.

3. Which salary fact from pages 1-3 cannot be compared directly with the national medians above? Name its source, place, or measure.

4. Which career would you investigate next? Use two facts from this page or your three app records, and name one thing the data cannot tell you.

IT Career Fit Reflection (complete on Day 5)

1. My Xello Personality Style result included _____. One example is _____

2. The IT pathway or career I reviewed was _____. It fits / does not fit / might fit me because _____

3. One salary, preparation, task, or demand fact that changed or confirmed my thinking was _____

4. **Final call:** Can I see myself working in IT? Yes, no, or not sure. Use evidence from this week. _____